

COMPANY POLICY HANDBOOK

A Complete Guide to Workplace Policies & Procedures

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Approved by:	Chief Executive Officer

This handbook outlines the policies, procedures, and guidelines applicable to all employees. All employees are expected to read, understand, and adhere to these policies. This document supersedes all previous versions.

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1. LEAVE POLICY

XYZ Corporation recognizes that employees require time off for personal, medical, and recreational purposes. The following leave categories are available to all confirmed employees:

1.1 Annual / Earned Leave (EL)

All permanent employees are entitled to 18 days of earned leave per calendar year, accrued at 1.5 days per month. Unused leave can be carried forward up to a maximum of 30 days.

- Minimum 3 days' advance notice required for planned leave.
- Leave encashment is permitted at the time of separation or year-end (max 10 days).

1.2 Sick Leave (SL)

Employees are entitled to 12 days of paid sick leave per year. A medical certificate is mandatory for absences exceeding 3 consecutive days.

1.3 Casual Leave (CL)

6 days of casual leave are provided per year for unplanned or personal exigencies. Casual leave cannot be combined with earned leave or public holidays.

1.4 Maternity Leave

Female employees are entitled to 26 weeks of paid maternity leave as per the Maternity Benefit (Amendment) Act, 2017. This applies to the first two children. Adoption leave of 12 weeks is available for mothers adopting a child below 3 months.

1.5 Paternity Leave

Male employees are entitled to 5 days of paid paternity leave within 30 days of the birth of a child.

1.6 Public Holidays

Employees observe 10 national and regional public holidays per year. A holiday calendar is published at the beginning of each year by the HR department.

Note: Leave without pay (LWP) will be recorded when the employee has exhausted all eligible leave balances.

2. CODE OF CONDUCT

Every employee represents the company and is expected to maintain the highest standards of professionalism, integrity, and ethical behavior at all times.

2.1 Professional Behavior

- Treat all colleagues, clients, and partners with respect and courtesy.
- Maintain confidentiality of sensitive business information.
- Avoid conflicts of interest; disclose any potential conflicts to HR immediately.
- Do not engage in activities that damage the company's reputation.

2.2 Dress Code

Business casual attire is required Monday through Thursday. Casual Fridays are permitted. Client-facing roles must maintain formal dress standards at all times.

2.3 Social Media & Public Communications

Employees must not share confidential company information, financial data, or unreleased product details on any public platform. Personal opinions expressed on social media must not be attributed to the company.

2.4 Disciplinary Action

Violations of the Code of Conduct may result in verbal warning, written warning, suspension, or termination depending on severity. All disciplinary actions are documented and stored in the employee's personnel file.

3. WORK HOURS & ATTENDANCE

3.1 Standard Work Hours

The standard work week is 40 hours, Monday through Friday, 9:00 AM to 6:00 PM with a one-hour lunch break. Flexible working arrangements may be approved by department heads on a case-by-case basis.

3.2 Remote Work Policy

Eligible employees may work remotely up to 2 days per week, subject to manager approval and role suitability. Remote employees must be reachable during core hours (10 AM – 4 PM) and maintain the same productivity standards.

3.3 Attendance & Punctuality

- Employees must mark attendance through the official HR portal or biometric system.
- Three late arrivals in a month (more than 15 minutes) will be considered one day of leave.
- Excessive or habitual absenteeism is subject to disciplinary action.

3.4 Overtime

Overtime is compensated at 1.5x the regular hourly rate for non-exempt employees. Pre-approval from the department head is required. Compensatory Off (Comp-Off) may be provided in lieu of overtime pay.

4. COMPENSATION & BENEFITS

4.1 Salary & Payroll

Salaries are disbursed on the last working day of each month via direct bank transfer. Salary slips are available on the employee self-service portal. Any discrepancies must be reported to HR within 7 working days.

4.2 Performance Bonuses

Annual performance bonuses are awarded based on individual KPIs, team performance, and company profitability. Bonus amounts range from 5% to 30% of the annual CTC and are communicated in March each year.

4.3 Health Insurance

All employees and their immediate family (spouse + 2 children) are covered under the Group Medclaim Policy up to INR 5,00,000 per annum. Pre-existing conditions are covered after a 30-day waiting period.

4.4 Provident Fund & Gratuity

- 12% of basic salary contributed to EPF by both employee and employer.
- Gratuity is payable after 5 years of continuous service as per the Payment of Gratuity Act.

4.5 Other Benefits

- Meal coupons / cafeteria subsidy: INR 2,200/month
- Internet reimbursement for remote workers: up to INR 1,000/month
- Learning & Development budget: INR 15,000/year per employee
- Employee Assistance Program (EAP): free counseling sessions

5. ANTI-HARASSMENT & DISCRIMINATION POLICY

XYZ Corporation is committed to maintaining a workplace free from harassment, bullying, and discrimination of any kind. All employees are entitled to a safe and respectful work environment.

5.1 Prohibited Conduct

- Sexual harassment, including unwelcome advances, quid pro quo, or hostile environment.
- Discrimination based on gender, race, religion, nationality, age, disability, or sexual orientation.
- Workplace bullying, intimidation, or verbal/physical abuse.

5.2 Internal Complaints Committee (ICC)

As mandated by the POSH Act, 2013, the company has constituted an Internal Complaints Committee. Any employee who experiences or witnesses harassment must report it to the ICC within 3 months of the incident.

5.3 Investigation Process

All complaints are treated confidentially. The ICC will complete its inquiry within 90 days. Both parties will be heard, and a fair decision communicated in writing. Retaliation against complainants is strictly prohibited.

Note: Contact the ICC at icc@xyzcompany.com or in person at HR Office, Floor 3.

6. IT & DATA SECURITY POLICY

All employees are responsible for protecting the company's digital assets, data, and IT infrastructure from unauthorized access, breaches, and misuse.

6.1 Acceptable Use

- Company devices and internet access are for business use. Limited personal use is permitted.
- Downloading unlicensed software or accessing inappropriate websites is prohibited.
- Employees must lock their screens when away from their workstation.

6.2 Password & Access Management

- Passwords must be at least 12 characters, changed every 90 days, and not reused.
- Multi-factor authentication (MFA) is mandatory for all company systems.
- Credentials must never be shared with anyone, including IT staff.

6.3 Data Handling

All customer and employee data is classified as confidential. Data must only be stored in company-approved platforms. Transferring sensitive data to personal devices or unapproved cloud storage is prohibited.

6.4 Incident Reporting

Any suspected data breach, phishing attempt, or security incident must be reported to IT Security immediately at security@xyzcompany.com. Timely reporting is critical to minimize risk.

7. HEALTH & SAFETY POLICY

The company is committed to providing a safe, healthy, and accident-free workplace in compliance with all applicable regulations.

7.1 General Safety Rules

- All employees must follow fire safety, emergency exit, and evacuation procedures.
- First aid kits are located on every floor. Trained first aiders are identified by a green badge.
- Report any unsafe conditions, hazards, or accidents to the Facilities team immediately.

7.2 Emergency Procedures

In case of fire or emergency: activate the alarm, evacuate via the nearest emergency exit, assemble at the designated muster point, and await instructions from the Safety Officer. Do not use elevators during emergencies.

7.3 Workplace Ergonomics

Employees should ensure proper seating posture, monitor height, and lighting. The company provides ergonomic assessments upon request. Regular breaks are encouraged to reduce repetitive strain injuries.

7.4 Mental Health & Well-being

The company recognizes mental health as equally important as physical health. Employees experiencing stress, burnout, or personal difficulties are encouraged to use the Employee Assistance Program (EAP) for free, confidential support.

8. PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT

A structured performance management process helps employees grow, align with company goals, and achieve their full potential.

8.1 Goal Setting

At the start of each year, employees and managers collaboratively set SMART goals aligned with departmental and organizational objectives. Goals are documented on the HR portal.

8.2 Mid-Year Review

A mid-year review is conducted in July to assess progress, provide feedback, and make adjustments to goals if required. This is not a formal appraisal but a developmental conversation.

8.3 Annual Appraisal

Annual performance appraisals are conducted in January–February for the preceding year. Ratings are on a 5-point scale: Exceptional, Exceeds Expectations, Meets Expectations, Needs Improvement, Unsatisfactory.

8.4 Performance Improvement Plan (PIP)

Employees rated 'Needs Improvement' for two consecutive cycles may be placed on a PIP. A PIP outlines specific improvement targets, timelines (typically 60–90 days), and support provided by management.

9. GRIEVANCE REDRESSAL POLICY

The company provides a fair and accessible mechanism for employees to raise work-related complaints and concerns without fear of retaliation.

9.1 Scope

This policy covers grievances relating to working conditions, interpersonal conflicts, policy interpretation, compensation discrepancies, and managerial conduct.

9.2 Grievance Procedure

Step	Action	Timeline
1	Informal Discussion with immediate manager	Within 7 days
2	Formal written complaint submitted to HR	Within 14 days
3	HR investigation and mediation	Within 21 days
4	Escalation to HR Head / Senior Management	Within 30 days
5	Final decision communicated in writing	Within 45 days

Note: All grievances are handled confidentially. Anonymous complaints may be submitted via the HR portal.

10. TERMINATION & EXIT POLICY

The company aims to ensure a professional, respectful, and legally compliant exit process for all departing employees, regardless of the reason for separation.

10.1 Resignation

Employees wishing to resign must submit a written notice to their manager and HR. Notice periods apply as follows:

Employee Level	Notice Period
Junior / Entry Level (0–3 yrs)	30 days
Mid-Level (3–7 yrs)	60 days
Senior / Management (7+ yrs)	90 days

10.2 Termination by Company

The company may terminate employment for cause (e.g., gross misconduct, fraud, policy violation) or without cause (restructuring). Terminations for cause may be immediate. All other terminations follow the applicable notice period or pay in lieu thereof.

10.3 Exit Process

- Exit interview with HR is mandatory.
- Return all company assets: laptop, access cards, mobile devices, documents.
- Knowledge transfer to be completed before last working day.
- Full and Final (F&F;) settlement processed within 45 days of last working day.

10.4 Non-Disclosure & Non-Compete

Departing employees are bound by the confidentiality and non-disclosure clauses signed at onboarding. Non-compete obligations apply for 12 months post-separation within the same industry and geography, as specified in the employment contract.

Note: For exit-related queries, contact hr-exit@xyzcompany.com or visit the HR office.